LAUDATO SI' MOVEMENT

Catholics for Our Common Home

REGION OF THE MONTH: AFRICA

NOVEMBER 2026

Monthly Prayer Guide

We pray this month for communities in mining regions who defend their land and seek environmental justice, and for the rivers, soils and bodies wounded by extractivism. Through the storms, floods and voices of the Season of Creation just ended, open our ears to hear the cry of the earth and the cry of the poor as one single plea.



Every creature reminds us of the beauty of creation and our shared responsibility to protect it. Photo: PickPik

Editorial page

MONTHLY PRAYER GUIDE

From Living Water to Living Hope

The Season of Creation may have ended, but its message continues to flow. Every river carries a story, every drop of water sustains life, and every community reminds us of our sacred responsibility to care for our common home.

We turn our focus to Central Africa particularly in Cameroon where the River Kadei has lost life. Excessive mining activity has undermined human dignity of local populations and indigenous communities who frequently face forced land dispossession, land and water grabbing, unsafe working conditions, slave wages, and instances of child labor, turning resource-rich areas into depleted “sacrifice zones”.

In that Eastern part of Cameroon, water which was life before is now a source of death because of chemicals and heavy metals which affects fish. The fishermen and families around the river have lost their livelihood.

As we journey toward Advent, we are invited to transform this pain into purpose and our faith into action. Hope is not simply something we await; it is something we nurture through love, courage, and solidarity.

Together, let us keep living water and hope flowing.



Prayer of the month: Prayer for fundamental human rights

God of Justice
Water is life and a human right.
We pray for people who go miles away every day
to get water for their daily need.
Give us the courage and determination
to defend fundamental human rights in extractive areas.
We ask for the courage to actively combat
poverty, inequality, lack of work, land and housing,
and the denial of social and labor rights.
We pray for equality, that there would not be first,
second or third class people; much less the so-called
"disposable".
We also pray for those who defend human rights.
For those who risk their lives while fighting
for fundamental rights under dictatorships,
authoritarian regimes and even in democracies in crisis,
that they may see their sacrifice and their work bear
abundant fruit. Amen.

Hear Creation's Song

Monthly reflection to deepen our eco-conversion

The Power of a Right Decision for an Ongoing Ecological Conversion



Sr. Solange Lomessoas
Dominican Sisters de la Bienheureuse Imelda, Cameroon Chapter Animator
Yaounde, Cameroon

The journey towards communities and climate justice requires a history, a decision and a starting point.

Mine began when I joined a campaign organised by a minister who launched a campaign on plastic bags. I was assigned to represent my college. In our communities, plastics had become a serious issue because they were spread all over, looking dirty and endangering our ecosystem.

I joined meetings as a delegate at regional level; with my contribution, they saw potential in me.

In all schools, starting with mine, I started environmental clubs that would do programs of awareness using art and organized climate walks.

From that time, I felt called to this mission and never used plastic bags again, and committed to take more actions.

In 2019, I received an email from the Laudato Si' Movement inviting me to the Animators course, and I thought that was the best time to learn and join the movement. I did my training in 2020 and I started involving my sisters and students, doing nursery trees, flowers and poultry.

Now I live a simple life, I buy fewer clothes, and I mind how I consume and spend, including water and energy.

I am proud to have received the Laudato Si' Animators certificate and an advocacy certificate that I pursued after.

Every time I pray, I remember to pray for creatures as partners that we share our common home.

In order to stay connected to this ecological conversion, we pray in community and have our gathering every month with Laudato Si' Animators. We share our work and plan activities together. I do daily prayer and I also joined a contemplation community where we contemplate and pray Laudato Si Rosary.

Hear Creation's Cry

Take a moment to look at this image. What is the cry of creation saying to you today?



Kadei river in Cameroon polluted by chemicals from mining activities

Questions for reflection

- Extractivism leaves a deep mark on water. Where in your own region do you see mining or other extractive activities affecting the rivers, lakes, or wells that sustain life — and whose voices are too often unheard in that struggle?
- Sister Solange's story began with her concern about plastic bags. What environmental problem—no matter how small it may seem—in your own community could serve as a starting point for deepening your own commitment to water and land justice?
- **Small Action of the Month:** Reflect on the sacred dimension of water as expressed in our liturgy and traditions (holy water, baptism, etc.). Then, let that reverence be reflected in your daily life: use water as someone who cherishes a gift, and pray for communities whose water is threatened by extractivism.

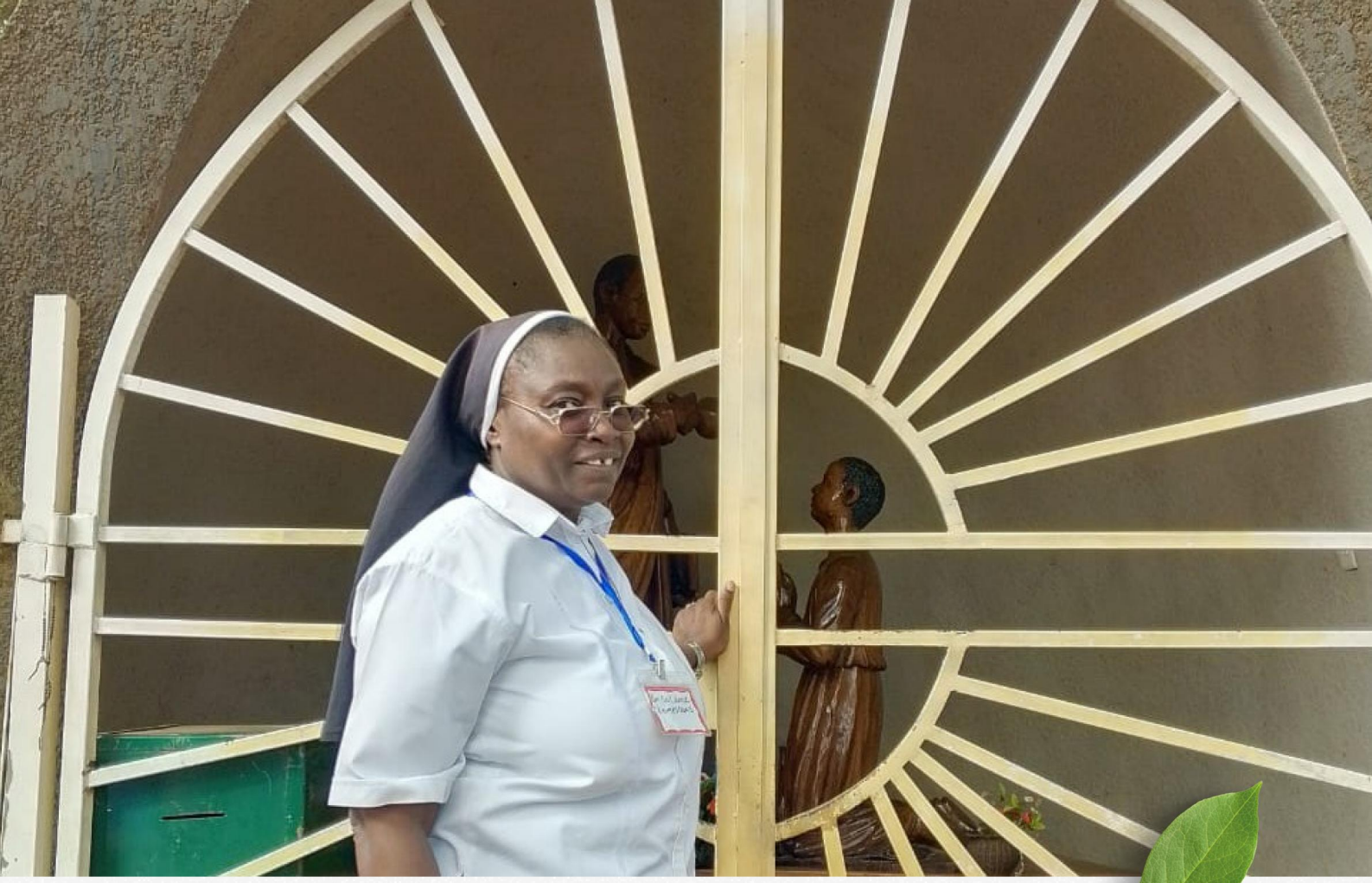
Hearing Creation's Call


Photo: PickPik

Five Years of Action, A Future of Hope

As we celebrate five years of the Laudato Si' Action Platform, we honor communities around the world turning faith into meaningful action for our common home. Be part of this growing journey of ecological conversion and help build a future rooted in hope.

Join the Laudato Si' Action Platform



LSM Monthly Prayer Guide

The LSM Monthly Prayer Guide invites our global family into shared prayer and ecological conversion. Each month, one region offers a prayer intention rooted in its local reality and opened to a shared global hope, in the spirit of Laudato Si'. Reflections, images, and testimonies from our members help us listen together to the Spirit's call in creation.

This prayer guide was developed with the support of Steeven Kezamutima from Kenya, Sr. Solange Lomessoas from Cameroon, Daniel Castellanos from Mexico, and the strategic work by Susana Salguero from El Salvador, design work by Marco Vargas from Ecuador, as well as work from others of the Communications team spread across the Americas and translators spread across the world.

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